Damn Fast DFIR — Windows Cheat Sheet

by MatthySoft

Live Windows triage commands per artifact, with the modern PowerShell, PS 2.0 / WMI and legacy cmd.exe fallback tiers.

OFFLINE FIELD REFERENCE
A4 print edition
20 Oct 2026
src: dfd_live_windows_baseliner_cheatsheet.html

1 · SYSTEM INFORMATION — OS, hardware, BIOS

POWERSHELL (PS 3.0+)

```
Get-CimInstance Win32_OperatingSystem
Get-CimInstance Win32_ComputerSystem
Get-CimInstance Win32_BIOS
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0 / WIN7)

```
Get-WmiObject Win32_OperatingSystem
Get-WmiObject Win32_ComputerSystem
Get-WmiObject Win32_BIOS
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic os get
   Caption,Version,BuildNumber,OSArchitecture,InstallDate,LastBootUp
   Time /format:list
wmic computersystem get
   Manufacturer,Model,TotalPhysicalMemory,NumberOfLogicalProcessors,
   Domain /format:list
wmic bios get SerialNumber /format:list
```

2 · LOCAL USERS & GROUPS — Local user accounts

POWERSHELL (PS 5.1+)

```
Get-LocalUser
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0)

```
Get-WmiObject Win32_UserAccount -Filter "LocalAccount=True"
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic useraccount where "LocalAccount=True" get
   Name,SID,Disabled,Lockout,PasswordRequired,PasswordExpires
   /format:list
```

2 · LOCAL USERS & GROUPS — Members of the local Administrators group

POWERSHELL (PS 5.1+)

```
Get-LocalGroupMember -Group Administrators
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0)

```
([ADSI]"WinNT://$env:COMPUTERNAME/Administrators,group").Members()
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
net localgroup administrators
```

3 · ACTIVE SESSIONS & PROFILES — Currently logged-on users

POWERSHELL (PS 3.0+)

```
Get-CimInstance Win32_LoggedOnUser
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0)

```
Get-WmiObject Win32_LoggedOnUser
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic path Win32_LoggedOnUser get Antecedent
```

3 · ACTIVE SESSIONS & PROFILES — User profiles on disk

POWERSHELL (PS 3.0+)

```
Get-CimInstance Win32_UserProfile -Filter "Special=False"
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0)

```
Get-WmiObject Win32_UserProfile -Filter "Special=False"
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic path Win32_UserProfile where "Special=False" get
   SID,LocalPath,LastUseTime,Loaded /format:list
```

4 · NETWORK — IP configuration per active interface

POWERSHELL (WIN8+ / PS 4.0+)

```
Get-NetIPConfiguration
```

4 · NETWORK — IP configuration per active interface (cont.)

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0 / WIN7)

```
Get-WmiObject Win32_NetworkAdapterConfiguration -Filter
   "IPEnabled=True"
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic nicconfig where "IPEnabled=True" get
   Description,MACAddress,IPAddress,DefaultIPGateway,DNSServerSearch
   Order /format:list
```

4 · NETWORK — Active TCP/UDP connections with owning process PID

POWERSHELL (WIN8+ / PS 4.0+)

```
Get-NetTCPConnection
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0 / WIN7) / LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
netstat -ano
```

4 · NETWORK — TCP listeners and UDP endpoints

POWERSHELL (WIN8+ / PS 4.0+)

```
Get-NetTCPConnection -State Listen
Get-NetUDPEndpoint
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0 / WIN7) / LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
netstat -ano
```

4 · NETWORK — DNS resolver cache

POWERSHELL (WIN8+ / PS 4.0+)

```
Get-DnsClientCache
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0 / WIN7) / LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
ipconfig /displaydns
```

4 · NETWORK — ARP / neighbor cache

POWERSHELL (WIN8+ / PS 4.0+)

```
Get-NetNeighbor
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0 / WIN7) / LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
arp -a
```

4 · NETWORK — Active routing table

POWERSHELL (WIN8+ / PS 4.0+)

```
Get-NetRoute
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0 / WIN7)

```
Get-WmiObject Win32_IP4RouteTable
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
route print
```

4 · NETWORK — SMB shares

POWERSHELL (WIN8+ / PS 4.0+)

```
Get-SmbShare
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0 / WIN7)

```
Get-WmiObject Win32_Share
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic share get Name,Path,Description /format:list
```

5 · PROCESSES & SERVICES — Running processes (path, command line, parent, owner, SHA256 hash)

POWERSHELL (PS 3.0+)

```
Get-CimInstance Win32_Process
Get-Process -IncludeUserName
Invoke-CimMethod -MethodName GetOwner
```

5 · PROCESSES & SERVICES Running processes (path, command line, parent, owner, SHA256 hash) (cont.)

POWERSHELL (PS 3.0+)

```
Get-FileHash -Algorithm SHA256
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0)

```
Get-WmiObject Win32_Process
Get-Process
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic process get
   Name,ProcessId,ParentProcessId,ExecutablePath,CommandLine
   /format:list
```

5 · PROCESSES & SERVICES Services (state, start mode, account, binary path)

POWERSHELL (PS 3.0+)

```
Get-CimInstance Win32_Service
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0)

```
Get-WmiObject Win32_Service
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic service get
   Name,DisplayName,State,StartMode,StartName,PathName,ProcessId
   /format:list
```

6 · SCHEDULED TASKS Enabled non-Microsoft scheduled tasks

POWERSHELL (WIN8+ / PS 4.0+)

```
Get-ScheduledTask
```

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0 / WIN7)

```
schtasks /query /fo CSV /v
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic path Win32_ScheduledJob get JobId,Command,DaysOfWeek
   /format:list
schtasks /query /fo LIST
```

7 · PERSISTENCE / AUTORUNS Run and RunOnce keys (HKLM and HKCU, including Wow6432Node)

POWERSHELL

```
Get-ItemProperty HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run
Get-ItemProperty
   HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnce
Get-ItemProperty
   HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Wow6432Node\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run
Get-ItemProperty HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run
Get-ItemProperty
   HKCU:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnce
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
reg query "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run"
reg query "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnce"
reg query
   "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Wow6432Node\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run"
reg query "HKCU\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run"
reg query "HKCU\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\RunOnce"
```

7 · PERSISTENCE / AUTORUNS Items in per-user and common Startup folders

POWERSHELL

```
Get-ChildItem "$env:ProgramData\Microsoft\Windows\Start
   Menu\Programs\Startup"
Get-ChildItem "$env:AppData\Microsoft\Windows\Start
   Menu\Programs\Startup"
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
dir "%ALLUSERSPROFILE%\Microsoft\Windows\Start
   Menu\Programs\Startup"
dir "%APPDATA%\Microsoft\Windows\Start Menu\Programs\Startup"
```

7 · PERSISTENCE / AUTORUNS WMI permanent event consumer subscriptions

POWERSHELL (PS 3.0+)

```
Get-CimInstance -Namespace root\subscription -ClassName
   __EventConsumer
```

7 · PERSISTENCE / AUTORUNS WMI permanent event consumer subscriptions (cont.)

POWERSHELL (PS 2.0)

```
Get-WmiObject -Namespace root\subscription -Class __EventConsumer
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic /namespace:\\root\subscription path __EventConsumer get
   /format:list
```

8 · SOFTWARE & PATCHES Installed software from registry uninstall hives

POWERSHELL

```
Get-ItemProperty
   HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall\*
Get-ItemProperty
   HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Wow6432Node\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Unins
   tall\*
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
reg query "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall"
   /s
reg query
   "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Wow6432Node\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Unins
   tall" /s
```

8 · SOFTWARE & PATCHES Installed Windows patches and hotfixes

POWERSHELL

```
Get-HotFix
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic qfe get HotFixID,Description,InstalledBy,InstalledOn
   /format:list
```

9 · FIREWALL Firewall profile state

POWERSHELL (WIN8+ / PS 4.0+)

```
Get-NetFirewallProfile
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE (VISTA+)

```
netsh advfirewall show allprofiles state
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE (XP FALLBACK)

```
netsh firewall show opmode
```

10 · EVENT LOGS Failed logon attempts

Last 7 days — requires Administrator.

Vista+ ID: 4625 · XP IDs: 529, 530, 531, 532, 533

POWERSHELL

```
Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable @{LogName='Security'; Id=4625;
   StartTime=(Get-Date).AddDays(-7)}
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic path Win32_NTLogEvent where "(Logfile='Security') and
   (EventCode=529 or EventCode=530 or EventCode=531 or EventCode=532
   or EventCode=533 or EventCode=4625)" get
   TimeWritten,EventCode,Message /format:list
```

10 · EVENT LOGS Successful logons (interactive and network)

Vista+ ID: 4624 · XP IDs: 528, 540

POWERSHELL

```
Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable @{LogName='Security'; Id=4624;
   StartTime=(Get-Date).AddDays(-7)}
```

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic path Win32_NTLogEvent where "(Logfile='Security') and
   (EventCode=528 or EventCode=540 or EventCode=4624)" get
   TimeWritten,EventCode,Message /format:list
```

10 · EVENT LOGS Account create, enable, modify, and group changes

Vista+ IDs: 4720, 4722, 4724, 4728, 4732, 4756 · XP IDs: 624, 626, 629, 632, 636

POWERSHELL

```
Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable @{LogName='Security';
   Id=4720,4722,4724,4728,4732,4756; StartTime=(Get-
   Date).AddDays(-7)}
```

10 · EVENT LOGS **Account create, enable, modify, and group changes**

(cont.)

LEGACY / CMD.EXE

```
wmic path Win32_NTLogEvent where "(Logfile='Security') and
   (EventCode=624 or EventCode=626 or EventCode=629 or EventCode=632
   or EventCode=636 or EventCode=4720 or EventCode=4722 or
   EventCode=4724 or EventCode=4728 or EventCode=4732 or
   EventCode=4756)" get TimeWritten,EventCode,Message /format:list
```